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1 In my first book, O Theophilus, I wrote about all that Jesus began to do and
to teach, [2] until the day He was taken up to heaven, after giving instructions through
the Holy Spirit to the apostles He had chosen. [3] After His suffering, He presented
Himself to them with many convincing proofs that He was alive. He appeared to
them over a span of forty days and spoke about the kingdom of God. [4] And while
they were gathered together, He commanded them: "Do not leave Jerusalem, but
wait for the gift the Father promised, which you have heard Me discuss." [5] "For John
baptized with water, but in a few days you will be baptized with the Holy Spirit."
[6] So when they came together, they asked Him, "Lord, will You at this time restore
the kingdom to Israel?" [7] Jesus replied, "It is not for you to know times or seasons
that the Father has fixed by His own authority."

[8] "But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes upon you, and you
will be My witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends
of the earth." [9] After He had said this, they watched as He was taken up, and a
cloud hid Him from their sight. [10] They were looking intently into the sky as He
was going, when suddenly two men dressed in white stood beside them. [11] "Men of
Galilee," they said, "why do you stand here looking into the sky? This same Jesus,
who has been taken from you into heaven, will come back in the same way you have
seen Him go into heaven."

[12] Then they returned to Jerusalem from the Mount of Olives, which is near the
city, a Sabbath day's journey away. [13] When they arrived, they went to the upper
room where they were staying: Peter and John, James and Andrew, Philip and
Thomas, Bartholomew and Matthew, James son of Alphaeus, Simon the Zealot,
and Judas son of James. [14] With one accord they all continued in prayer, along with
the women and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with His brothers. [15] In those days
Peter stood up among the brothers (a gathering of about a hundred and twenty)
and said, [16] "Brothers, the Scripture had to be fulfilled which the Holy Spirit
foretold through the mouth of David concerning Judas, who became a guide for
those who arrested Jesus."

[17] "He was one of our number and shared in this ministry." [18] (Now with the reward
for his wickedness Judas bought a field; there he fell headlong and burst open in the
middle, and all his intestines spilled out. [19] This became known to all who lived in
Jerusalem, so they called that field in their own language Akeldama, that is, Field
of Blood.) [20] "For it is written in the book of Psalms: 'May his place be deserted; let
there be no one to dwell in it,' and, 'May another take his position.'" [21] Therefore
it is necessary to choose one of the men who have accompanied us the whole time
the Lord Jesus went in and out among us, [22] "beginning from John's baptism until
the day Jesus was taken up from us. For one of these must become a witness with
us of His resurrection." [23] So they proposed two men: Joseph called Barsabbas (also
known as Justus) and Matthias. [24] And they prayed, "Lord, You know everyone's
heart. Show us which of these two You have chosen" [25] "to take up this ministry
and apostleship, which Judas abandoned to go to his rightful place." [26] Then they
cast lots, and the lot fell to Matthias; so he was added to the eleven apostles.

2 When the day of Pentecost came, they were all together in one place. [2] Suddenly
a sound like a mighty rushing wind came from heaven and filled the whole house
where they were sitting. [3] They saw tongues like flames of fire that separated and
came to rest on each of them. [4] And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and
began to speak in other tongues as the Spirit enabled them. [5] Now there were
dwelling in Jerusalem God-fearing Jews from every nation under heaven. [6] And
when this sound rang out, a crowd came together in bewilderment, because each
one heard them speaking his own language. [7] Astounded and amazed, they asked,
"Are not all these men who are speaking Galileans?" [8] How is it then that each
of us hears them in his own native language? [9] Parthians, Medes, and Elamites;
residents of Mesopotamia, Judea and Cappadocia, Pontus and Asia, [10] Phrygia and
Pamphylia, Egypt and the parts of Libya near Cyrene; visitors from Rome, [11] "both
Jews and converts to Judaism; Cretans and Arabs—we hear them declaring the
wonders of God in our own tongues!" [12] Astounded and perplexed, they asked one
another, "What does this mean?" [13] But others mocked them and said, "They are
drunk on new wine!"

[14] Then Peter stood up with the Eleven, lifted up his voice, and addressed the crowd:
"Men of Judea and all who dwell in Jerusalem, let this be known to you, and listen
carefully to my words."

[15] These men are not drunk, as you suppose. It is only the third hour of the day!
[16] No, this is what was spoken by the prophet Joel: [17] 'In the last days, God says,
I will pour out My Spirit on all people. Your sons and daughters will prophesy,
your young men will see visions, your old men will dream dreams.' [18] Even on My
menservants and maidservants I will pour out My Spirit in those days, and they
will prophesy. [19] I will show wonders in the heavens above and signs on the earth
below, blood and fire and billows of smoke. [20] The sun will be turned to darkness,
and the moon to blood, before the coming of the great and glorious Day of
the Lord. [21] And everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved.'

[22] Men of Israel, listen to this message: Jesus of Nazareth was a man certified by
God to you by miracles, wonders, and signs, which God did among you through
Him, as you yourselves know. [23] He was delivered up by God's set plan and
foreknowledge, and you, by the hands of the lawless, put Him to death by nailing
Him to the cross. [24] But God raised Him from the dead, releasing Him from the
agony of death, because it was impossible for Him to be held in its clutches. [25] David
says about Him: 'I saw the Lord always before me; because He is at my right hand,
I will not be shaken.' [26] Therefore my heart is glad and my tongue rejoices; my body
also will dwell in hope, [27] because You will not abandon my soul to Hades, nor will
You let Your Holy One see decay. [28] You have made known to me the paths of life;
You will fill me with joy in Your presence.' [29] Brothers, I can tell you with confidence
that the patriarch David died and was buried, and his tomb is with us to this day.
[30] But he was a prophet and knew that God had promised him on oath that He
would place one of his descendants on his throne.

[31] Foreseeing this, David spoke about the resurrection of the Christ, that He was
not abandoned to Hades, nor did His body see decay. [32] God has raised this Jesus
to life, to which we are all witnesses. [33] Exalted, then, to the right hand of God, He
has received from the Father the promised Holy Spirit and has poured out what
you now see and hear. [34] For David did not ascend into heaven, but he himself says:
'The Lord said to my Lord, "Sit at My right hand"' [35] "until I make Your enemies
a footstool for Your feet."' [36] "Therefore let all Israel know with certainty that God
has made this Jesus, whom you crucified, both Lord and Christ!"

[37] When the people heard this, they were cut to the heart and asked Peter and
the other apostles, "Brothers, what shall we do?" [38] Peter replied, "Repent and be
baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your
sins, and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit." [39] "This promise belongs to
you and your children and to all who are far off—to all whom the Lord our God
will call to Himself." [40] With many other words he testified, and he urged them,
"Be saved from this corrupt generation." [41] Those who embraced his message were
baptized, and about three thousand were added to the believers that day.

[42] They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching and to the fellowship, to the
breaking of bread and to prayer. [43] A sense of awe came over everyone, and the
apostles performed many wonders and signs. [44] All the believers were together and
had everything in common. [45] Selling their possessions and goods, they shared with
anyone who was in need. [46] With one accord they continued to meet daily in the
temple courts and to break bread from house to house, sharing their meals with
gladness and sincerity of heart, [47] praising God and enjoying the favor of all the
people. And the Lord added to their number daily those who were being saved.

3 One afternoon Peter and John were going up to the temple at the hour of
prayer, the ninth hour. [2] And a man who was lame from birth was being carried
to the temple gate called Beautiful, where he was put every day to beg from those
entering the temple courts. [3] When he saw Peter and John about to enter, he asked
them for money. [4] Peter looked directly at him, as did John. "Look at us!" said Peter.
[5] So the man gave them his attention, expecting to receive something from them.
[6] But Peter said, "Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give you: In the name
of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, get up and walk!" [7] Taking him by the right hand, Peter
helped him up, and at once the man's feet and ankles were made strong.

[8] He sprang to his feet and began to walk. Then he went with them into the
temple courts, walking and leaping and praising God. [9] When all the people saw
him walking and praising God, [10] they recognized him as the man who used to
sit begging at the Beautiful Gate of the temple, and they were filled with wonder
and amazement at what had happened to him. [11] While the man clung to Peter
and John, all the people were astonished and ran to them in the walkway called
Solomon's Colonnade. [12] And when Peter saw this, he addressed the people: "Men
of Israel, why are you surprised by this? Why do you stare at us as if by our own
power or godliness we had made this man walk?" [13] The God of Abraham, Isaac,
and Jacob, the God of our fathers, has glorified His servant Jesus. You handed Him
over and rejected Him before Pilate, even though he had decided to release Him.
[14] You rejected the Holy and Righteous One and asked that a murderer be released
to you. [15] You killed the Author of life, but God raised Him from the dead, and we
are witnesses of the fact. [16] By faith in the name of Jesus, this man whom you see
and know has been made strong. It is Jesus' name and the faith that comes through
Him that has given him this complete healing in your presence.

[17] And now, brothers, I know that you acted in ignorance, as did your leaders. [18] But
in this way God has fulfilled what He foretold through all the prophets, saying that
His Christ would suffer.

[19] Repent, then, and turn back, so that your sins may be wiped away, [20] that times
of refreshing may come from the presence of the Lord, and that He may send Jesus,

the Christ, who has been appointed for you. [21] Heaven must take Him in until the time comes for the restoration of all things, which God announced long ago through His holy prophets. [22] For Moses said, 'The Lord your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your brothers. You must listen to Him in everything He tells you.' [23] Everyone who does not listen to Him will be completely cut off from among his people.' [24] Indeed, all the prophets from Samuel on, as many as have spoken, have proclaimed these days. [25] And you are sons of the prophets and of the covenant God made with your fathers when He said to Abraham, 'Through your offspring all the families of the earth will be blessed.' [26] "When God raised up His Servant, He sent Him first to you to bless you by turning each of you from your wicked ways."

4 While Peter and John were speaking to the people, the priests and the captain of the temple guard and the Sadducees came up to them, [2] greatly disturbed that they were teaching the people and proclaiming in Jesus the resurrection of the dead. [3] They seized Peter and John, and because it was evening, they put them in custody until the next day. [4] But many who heard the message believed, and the number of men grew to about five thousand. [5] The next day the rulers, elders, and scribes assembled in Jerusalem, [6] along with Annas the high priest, Caiaphas, John, Alexander, and many others from the high priest's family. [7] They had Peter and John brought in and began to question them: "By what power or what name did you do this?" [8] Then Peter, filled with the Holy Spirit, said to them, "Rulers and elders of the people! [9] If we are being examined today about a kind service to a man who was lame, to determine how he was healed, [10] then let this be known to all of you and to all the people of Israel: It is by the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, whom you crucified but whom God raised from the dead, that this man stands before you healed. [11] This Jesus is 'the stone you builders rejected, which has become the cornerstone.'

[12] "Salvation exists in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven given to men by which we must be saved." [13] When they saw the boldness of Peter and John and realized that they were unschooled, ordinary men, they marveled and took note that these men had been with Jesus. [14] And seeing the man who had been healed standing there with them, they had nothing to say in response. [15] So they ordered them to leave the Sanhedrin and then conferred together. [16] "What shall we do with these men?" they asked. "It is clear to everyone living in Jerusalem that a remarkable miracle has occurred through them, and we cannot deny it." [17] "But to keep this message from spreading any further among the people, we must warn them not to speak to anyone in this name." [18] Then they called them in again and commanded them not to speak or teach at all in the name of Jesus.

[19] But Peter and John replied, "Judge for yourselves whether it is right in God's sight to listen to you rather than God." [20] "For we cannot stop speaking about what we have seen and heard." [21] After further threats they let them go. They could not find a way to punish them, because all the people were glorifying God for what had happened. [22] For the man who was miraculously healed was over forty years old. [23] On their release, Peter and John returned to their own people and reported everything that the chief priests and elders had said to them.

[24] When the believers heard this, they lifted up their voices to God with one accord. "Sovereign Lord," they said, "You made the heaven and the earth and the sea and everything in them." [25] You spoke by the Holy Spirit through the mouth of Your servant, our father David: 'Why do the nations rage and the peoples plot in vain?' [26] The kings of the earth take their stand and the rulers gather together against the Lord and against His Anointed One.' [27] In fact, this is the very city where Herod and Pontius Pilate conspired with the Gentiles and the people of Israel against Your holy servant Jesus, whom You anointed. [28] They carried out what Your hand and will had decided beforehand would happen. [29] And now, Lord, consider their threats, and enable Your servants to speak Your word with complete boldness, [30] "as You stretch out Your hand to heal and perform signs and wonders through the name of Your holy servant Jesus." [31] After they had prayed, their meeting place was shaken, and they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and spoke the word of God boldly. [32] The multitude of believers was one in heart and soul. No one claimed that any of his possessions was his own, but they shared everything they owned. [33] With great power the apostles continued to give their testimony about the resurrection of the Lord Jesus. And abundant grace was upon them all. [34] There were no needy ones among them, because those who owned lands or houses would sell their property, bring the proceeds from the sales, [35] and lay them at the apostles' feet for distribution to anyone as he had need. [36] Joseph, a Levite from Cyprus, whom the apostles called Barnabas (meaning Son of Encouragement), [37] sold a field he owned, brought the money, and laid it at the apostles' feet.

5 Now a man named Ananias, together with his wife Sapphira, also sold a piece of property. [2] With his wife's full knowledge, he kept back some of the proceeds for himself, but brought a portion and laid it at the apostles' feet. [3] Then Peter said, "Ananias, how is it that Satan has filled your heart to lie to the Holy Spirit and withhold some of the proceeds from the land?" [4] "Did it not belong to you before it was sold? And after it was sold, was it not at your disposal? How could you conceive such a deed in your heart? You have not lied to men, but to God!" [5] On hearing these words, Ananias fell down and died. And great fear came over all who heard what had happened. [6] Then the young men stepped forward, wrapped up his body, and carried him out and buried him. [7] About three hours later his wife also came in, unaware of what had happened. [8] "Tell me," said Peter, "is this the price you and your husband got for the land?" "Yes," she answered, "that is the price." [9] "How could you agree to test the Spirit of the Lord?" Peter replied. "Look, the feet of the men who buried your husband are at the door, and they will carry you out also." [10] At that instant she fell down at his feet and died. Then the young men came in and, finding her dead, carried her out and buried her beside her husband. [11] And great fear came over the whole church and all who heard about these events. [12] The apostles performed many signs and wonders among the people, and with one accord the believers gathered together in Solomon's Colonnade. [13] Although the people regarded them highly, no one else dared to join them.

[14] Yet more and more believers were brought to the Lord—large numbers of both men and women. [15] As a result, people brought the sick into the streets and laid them on cots and mats, so that at least Peter's shadow might fall on some of them as he passed by. [16] Crowds also gathered from the towns around Jerusalem, bringing the sick and those tormented by unclean spirits, and all of them were healed.

[17] Then the high priest and all his associates, who belonged to the party of the Sadducees, were filled with jealousy. They went out [18] and arrested the apostles and put them in the public jail. [19] But during the night an angel of the Lord opened the doors of the jail and brought them out, saying, [20] "Go, stand in the temple courts and tell the people the full message of this new life." [21] At daybreak the apostles entered the temple courts as they had been told and began to teach the people. When the high priest and his associates arrived, they convened the Sanhedrin—the full assembly of the elders of Israel—and sent to the jail for the apostles. [22] But on arriving at the jail, the officers did not find them there. So they returned with the report: [23] "We found the jail securely locked, with the guards posted at the doors; but when we opened them, we found no one inside." [24] When the captain of the temple guard and the chief priests heard this account, they were perplexed as to what was happening. [25] Then someone came in and announced, "Look, the men you put in jail are standing in the temple courts teaching the people!" [26] At that point, the captain went with the officers and brought the apostles—but not by force, for fear the people would stone them. [27] They brought them in and made them stand before the Sanhedrin, where the high priest interrogated them.

[28] "We gave you strict orders not to teach in this name," he said. "Yet you have filled Jerusalem with your teaching and are determined to make us responsible for this man's blood." [29] But Peter and the other apostles replied, "We must obey God rather than men." [30] The God of our fathers raised up Jesus, whom you had killed by hanging Him on a tree. [31] God exalted Him to His right hand as Prince and Savior, in order to grant repentance and forgiveness of sins to Israel. [32] "We are witnesses of these things, and so is the Holy Spirit, whom God has given to those who obey Him." [33] When the Council members heard this, they were enraged, and they resolved to put the apostles to death. [34] But a Pharisee named Gamaliel, a teacher of the law who was honored by all the people, stood up in the Sanhedrin and ordered that the men be put outside for a short time. [35] "Men of Israel," he said, "consider carefully what you are about to do to these men." [36] Some time ago Theudas rose up, claiming to be somebody, and about four hundred men joined him. He was killed, all his followers were dispersed, and it all came to nothing. [37] After him, Judas the Galilean appeared in the days of the census and drew away people after him. He too perished, and all his followers were scattered. [38] So in the present case I advise you: Leave these men alone. Let them go! For if their purpose or endeavor is of human origin, it will fail. [39] "But if it is from God, you will not be able to stop them. You may even find yourselves fighting against God." [40] At this, they yielded to Gamaliel. They called the apostles in and had them flogged. Then they ordered them not to speak in the name of Jesus, and released them. [41] The apostles left the Sanhedrin, rejoicing that they had been counted worthy of suffering disgrace for the Name. [42] Every day, in the temple courts and from house to house, they did not stop teaching and proclaiming the good news that Jesus is the Christ.

6 In those days when the disciples were increasing in number, the Grecian Jews among them began to grumble against the Hebraic Jews because their widows were being overlooked in the daily distribution of food. [2] So the Twelve summoned all the disciples and said, "It is unacceptable for us to neglect the word of God in order to wait on tables." [3] Therefore, brothers, select from among you seven men confirmed to be full of the Spirit and wisdom. We will appoint this responsibility to them [4] "and will devote ourselves to prayer and to the ministry of the word." [5] This proposal pleased the whole group. They chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Spirit, as well as Philip, Prochorus, Nicanor, Timon, Parmenas, and Nicolas from Antioch, a convert to Judaism. [6] They presented these seven to the apostles, who prayed and laid their hands on them. [7] So the word of God continued to spread. The number of disciples in Jerusalem grew rapidly, and a great number of priests became obedient to the faith. [8] Now Stephen, who was full of grace and power, was performing great wonders and signs among the people. [9] But resistance arose from what was called the Synagogue of the Freedmen, including Cyrenians, Alexandrians, and men from the provinces of Cilicia and Asia. They began to argue

with Stephen, [10] but they could not stand up to his wisdom or the Spirit by whom he spoke.

[11] Then they prompted some men to say, "We heard Stephen speak words of blasphemy against Moses and against God." [12] So they stirred up the people, elders, and scribes and confronted Stephen. They seized him and brought him before the Sanhedrin, [13] where they presented false witnesses who said, "This man never stops speaking against this holy place and against the law." [14] "For we have heard him say that Jesus of Nazareth will destroy this place and change the customs that Moses handed down to us." [15] All who were sitting in the Sanhedrin looked intently at Stephen, and they saw that his face was like the face of an angel.

7 Then the high priest asked Stephen, "Are these charges true?" [2] And Stephen declared: "Brothers and fathers, listen to me! The God of glory appeared to our father Abraham while he was still in Mesopotamia, before he lived in Haran," [3] and told him, 'Leave your country and your kindred and go to the land I will show you.' [4] So Abraham left the land of the Chaldeans and settled in Haran. After his father died, God brought him out of that place and into this land where you are now living. [5] He gave him no inheritance here, not even a foot of ground. But God promised to give possession of the land to Abraham and his descendants, even though he did not yet have a child. [6] God told him that his descendants would be foreigners in a strange land, and that they would be enslaved and mistreated four hundred years. [7] 'But I will punish the nation that enslaves them,' God said, 'and afterward they will come forth and worship Me in this place.' [8] Then God gave Abraham the covenant of circumcision, and Abraham became the father of Isaac and circumcised him on the eighth day. And Isaac became the father of Jacob, and Jacob of the twelve patriarchs. [9] Because the patriarchs were jealous of Joseph, they sold him as a slave into Egypt. But God was with him [10] and rescued him from all his troubles. He granted Joseph favor and wisdom in the sight of Pharaoh king of Egypt, who appointed him ruler over Egypt and all his household. [11] Then famine and great suffering swept across Egypt and Canaan, and our fathers could not find food. [12] When Jacob heard that there was grain in Egypt, he sent our fathers on their first visit. [13] On their second visit, Joseph revealed his identity to his brothers, and his family became known to Pharaoh. [14] Then Joseph sent for his father Jacob and all his relatives, seventy-five in all. [15] So Jacob went down to Egypt, where he and our fathers died. [16] Their bones were carried back to Shechem and placed in the tomb that Abraham had bought from the sons of Hamor at Shechem for a price he paid in silver. [17] As the time drew near for God to fulfill His promise to Abraham, our people in Egypt increased greatly in number. [18] Then another king, who knew nothing of Joseph, arose over Egypt. [19] He exploited our people and oppressed our fathers, forcing them to abandon their infants so they would die.

[20] At that time Moses was born, and he was beautiful in the sight of God. For three months he was nurtured in his father's house. [21] When he was set outside, Pharaoh's daughter took him and brought him up as her own son. [22] So Moses was educated in all the wisdom of the Egyptians and was powerful in speech and action. [23] When Moses was forty years old, he decided to visit his brothers, the children of Israel. [24] And when he saw one of them being mistreated, Moses went to his defense and avenged him by striking down the Egyptian who was oppressing him.

[25] He assumed his brothers would understand that God was using him to deliver them, but they did not. [26] The next day he came upon two Israelites who were fighting, and he tried to reconcile them, saying, 'Men, you are brothers. Why are you mistreating each other?' [27] But the man who was abusing his neighbor pushed Moses aside and said, 'Who made you ruler and judge over us?' [28] Do you want to kill me as you killed the Egyptian yesterday?' [29] At this remark, Moses fled to the land of Midian, where he lived as a foreigner and had two sons. [30] After forty years had passed, an angel appeared to Moses in the flames of a burning bush in the desert near Mount Sinai. [31] When Moses saw it, he marveled at the sight. As he approached to look more closely, the voice of the Lord came to him: [32] 'I am the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.' Moses trembled with fear and did not dare to look. [33] Then the Lord said to him, 'Take off your sandals, for the place where you are standing is holy ground.' [34] I have indeed seen the oppression of My people in Egypt. I have heard their groaning and have come down to deliver them. Now come, I will send you back to Egypt.' [35] This Moses, whom they had rejected with the words, 'Who made you ruler and judge?' is the one whom God sent to be their ruler and redeemer through the angel who appeared to him in the bush. [36] He led them out and performed wonders and signs in the land of Egypt, at the Red Sea, and for forty years in the wilderness. [37] This is the same Moses who told the Israelites, 'God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your brothers.' [38] He was in the assembly in the wilderness with the angel who spoke to him on Mount Sinai, and with our fathers. And he received living words to pass on to us. [39] But our fathers refused to obey him. Instead, they rejected him and in their hearts turned back to Egypt.

[40] They said to Aaron, 'Make us gods who will go before us! As for this Moses who led us out of the land of Egypt, we do not know what has happened to him.' [41] At that time they made a calf and offered a sacrifice to the idol, rejoicing in the works of their hands. [42] But God turned away from them and gave them over to the worship of the host of heaven, as it is written in the book of the prophets: 'Did you bring Me sacrifices and offerings forty years in the wilderness, O house of Israel?' [43] You have taken along the tabernacle of Molech and the star of your god Rephan, the idols you made to worship. Therefore I will send you into exile beyond Babylon.' [44] Our fathers had the tabernacle of the Testimony with them in the wilderness. It was constructed exactly as God had directed Moses, according to the pattern he had seen. [45] And our fathers who received it brought it in with Joshua when they dispossessed the nations God drove out before them. It remained until the time of David, [46] who found favor in the sight of God and asked to provide a dwelling place for the God of Jacob. [47] But it was Solomon who built the house for Him. [48] However, the Most High does not dwell in houses made by human hands. As the prophet says: [49] 'Heaven is My throne and the earth is My footstool. What kind of house will you build for Me, says the Lord, or where will My place of repose be?' [50] Has not My hand made all these things?' [51] You stiff-necked people with uncircumcised hearts and ears! You always resist the Holy Spirit, just as your fathers did. [52] Which of the prophets did your fathers fail to persecute? They even killed those who foretold the coming of the Righteous One. And now you are His betrayers and murderers— [53] "you who received the law ordained by angels, yet have not kept it." [54] On hearing this, the members of the Sanhedrin were enraged, and they gnashed their teeth at him. [55] But Stephen, full of the Holy Spirit, looked intently into heaven and saw the glory of God and Jesus standing at the right hand of God. [56] "Look," he said, "I see heaven open and the Son of Man standing at the right hand of God." [57] At this they covered their ears, cried out in a loud voice, and rushed together at him. [58] They dragged him out of the city and began to stone him. Meanwhile the witnesses laid their garments at the feet of a young man named Saul. [59] While they were stoning him, Stephen appealed, "Lord Jesus, receive my spirit." [60] Falling on his knees, he cried out in a loud voice, "Lord, do not hold this sin against them." And when he had said this, he fell asleep.

8 And Saul was there, giving approval to Stephen's death. On that day a great persecution broke out against the church in Jerusalem, and all except the apostles were scattered throughout Judea and Samaria. [2] God-fearing men buried Stephen and mourned deeply over him. [3] But Saul began to destroy the church. Going from house to house, he dragged off men and women and put them in prison. [4] Those who had been scattered preached the word wherever they went. [5] Philip went down to a city in Samaria and proclaimed the Christ to them. [6] The crowds gave their undivided attention to Philip's message and to the signs they saw him perform. [7] With loud shrieks, unclean spirits came out of many who were possessed, and many of the paralyzed and lame were healed. [8] So there was great joy in that city. [9] Prior to that time, a man named Simon had practiced sorcery in the city and astounded the people of Samaria. He claimed to be someone great, [10] and all the people, from the least to the greatest, heeded his words and said, "This man is the divine power called the Great Power." [11] They paid close attention to him because he had astounded them for a long time with his sorcery. [12] But when they believed Philip as he preached the gospel of the kingdom of God and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized, both men and women.

[13] Even Simon himself believed and was baptized. He followed Philip closely and was astounded by the great signs and miracles he observed. [14] When the apostles in Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent Peter and John to them. [15] On their arrival, they prayed for them to receive the Holy Spirit. [16] For the Holy Spirit had not yet fallen upon any of them; they had simply been baptized into the name of the Lord Jesus.

[17] Then Peter and John laid their hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit. [18] When Simon saw that the Spirit was given through the laying on of the apostles' hands, he offered them money. [19] "Give me this power as well," he said, "so that everyone on whom I lay my hands may receive the Holy Spirit." [20] But Peter replied, "May your silver perish with you, because you thought you could buy the gift of God with money!" [21] You have no part or share in our ministry, because your heart is not right before God. [22] Repent, therefore, of your wickedness, and pray to the Lord. Perhaps He will forgive you for the intent of your heart. [23] "For I see that you are poisoned by bitterness and captive to iniquity." [24] Then Simon answered, "Pray to the Lord for me, so that nothing you have said may happen to me." [25] And after Peter and John had testified and spoken the word of the Lord, they returned to Jerusalem, preaching the gospel in many of the Samaritan villages.

[26] Now an angel of the Lord said to Philip, "Get up and go south to the desert road that goes down from Jerusalem to Gaza." [27] So he started out, and on his way he met an Ethiopian eunuch, a court official in charge of the entire treasury of Candace, queen of the Ethiopians. He had gone to Jerusalem to worship, [28] and on his return was sitting in his chariot reading Isaiah the prophet. [29] The Spirit said to Philip, "Go over to that chariot and stay by it." [30] So Philip ran up and heard the man reading Isaiah the prophet. "Do you understand what you are reading?" Philip asked. [31] "How can I," he said, "unless someone guides me?" And he invited Philip to come up and sit with him. [32] The eunuch was reading this passage of Scripture: "He was led like a sheep to the slaughter, and as a lamb before the shearer is silent, so He did not open His mouth." [33] "In His humiliation He was deprived of justice. Who can recount His descendants? For His life was removed from the earth." [34] "Tell me," said the eunuch, "who is the prophet talking about, himself or someone else?"

35 Then Philip began with this very Scripture and told him the good news
about Jesus. 36 As they traveled along the road and came to some water, the eunuch
said, "Look, here is water! What is there to prevent me from being baptized?" 37 And
Philip said, If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. And he answered and
said, I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God. 38 And he gave orders to stop the
chariot. Then both Philip and the eunuch went down into the water, and Philip
baptized him. 39 When they came up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord carried
Philip away, and the eunuch saw him no more, but went on his way rejoicing. 40 But
Philip appeared at Azotus and traveled through that region, preaching the gospel
in all the towns until he came to Caesarea.

9 Meanwhile, Saul was still breathing out murderous threats against the disciples
of the Lord. He approached the high priest 2 and requested letters to the synagogues
in Damascus, so that if he found any men or women belonging to the Way, he
could bring them as prisoners to Jerusalem. 3 As Saul drew near to Damascus on his
journey, suddenly a light from heaven flashed around him. 4 He fell to the ground
and heard a voice say to him, "Saul, Saul, why do you persecute Me?" 5 "Who
are You, Lord?" Saul asked. "I am Jesus, whom you are persecuting," He replied.
6 "Now get up and go into the city, and you will be told what you must do." 7 The
men traveling with Saul stood there speechless. They heard the voice but did not
see anyone. 8 Saul got up from the ground, but when he opened his eyes he could
not see a thing. So they led him by the hand into Damascus. 9 For three days he
was without sight, and he did not eat or drink anything. 10 In Damascus there was
a disciple named Ananias. The Lord spoke to him in a vision, "Ananias!" "Here I
am, Lord," he answered. 11 "Get up!" the Lord told him. "Go to the house of Judas
on Straight Street and ask for a man from Tarsus named Saul, for he is praying."
12 "In a vision he has seen a man named Ananias come and place his hands on him to
restore his sight." 13 But Ananias answered, "Lord, many people have told me about
this man and all the harm he has done to Your saints in Jerusalem."

14 "And now he is here with authority from the chief priests to arrest all who call
on Your name." 15 "Go!" said the Lord. "This man is My chosen instrument to carry
My name before the Gentiles and their kings, and before the people of Israel." 16 "I
will show him how much he must suffer for My name." 17 So Ananias went to the
house, and when he arrived, he placed his hands on Saul. "Brother Saul," he said,
"the Lord Jesus, who appeared to you on the road as you were coming here, has sent
me so that you may see again and be filled with the Holy Spirit." 18 At that instant,
something like scales fell from Saul's eyes, and his sight was restored. He got up and
was baptized, 19 and after taking some food, he regained his strength. And he spent
several days with the disciples in Damascus. 20 Saul promptly began to proclaim
Jesus in the synagogues, declaring, "He is the Son of God." 21 All who heard him
were astounded and asked, "Isn't this the man who wreaked havoc in Jerusalem on
those who call on this name? And hasn't he come here to take them as prisoners
to the chief priests?" 22 But Saul was empowered all the more, and he confounded
the Jews living in Damascus by proving that Jesus is the Christ. 23 After many days
had passed, the Jews conspired to kill him, 24 but Saul learned of their plot. Day and
night they watched the city gates in order to kill him.

25 One night, however, his disciples took him and lowered him in a basket through
a window in the wall. 26 When Saul arrived in Jerusalem, he tried to join the disciples,
but they were all afraid of him, not believing that he was a disciple. 27 Then Barnabas
brought him to the apostles and described how Saul had seen the Lord, who spoke
to him on the road to Damascus, and how Saul had spoken boldly in that city in
the name of Jesus.

28 So Saul stayed with them, moving about freely in Jerusalem and speaking boldly
in the name of the Lord. 29 He talked and debated with the Grecian Jews, but
they tried to kill him. 30 When the brothers learned of this, they took him down
to Caesarea and sent him off to Tarsus. 31 Then the church throughout Judea,
Galilee, and Samaria experienced a time of peace. It grew in strength and numbers,
living in the fear of the Lord and the encouragement of the Holy Spirit. 32 As
Peter traveled throughout the area, he went to visit the saints in Lydda. 33 There he
found a man named Aeneas, who had been paralyzed and bedridden for eight years.
34 "Aeneas," Peter said to him, "Jesus Christ heals you! Get up and put away your
mat." Immediately Aeneas got up, 35 and all who lived in Lydda and Sharon saw him
and turned to the Lord. 36 In Joppa there was a disciple named Tabitha (which is
translated as Dorcas), who was always occupied with works of kindness and charity.
37 At that time, however, she became sick and died, and her body was washed and
placed in an upper room. 38 Since Lydda was near Joppa, the disciples heard that
Peter was there and sent two men to urge him, "Come to us without delay." 39 So
Peter got up and went with them. On his arrival, they took him to the upper room.
All the widows stood around him, weeping and showing him the tunics and other
clothing that Dorcas had made while she was still with them. 40 Then Peter sent
them all out of the room. He knelt down and prayed, and turning toward her body,
he said, "Tabitha, get up!" She opened her eyes, and seeing Peter, she sat up. 41 Peter
took her by the hand and helped her up. Then he called the saints and widows
and presented her to them alive. 42 This became known all over Joppa, and many
people believed in the Lord. 43 And Peter stayed for several days in Joppa with a
tanner named Simon.

10 At Caesarea there was a man named Cornelius, a centurion in what was
called the Italian Regiment. 2 He and all his household were devout and God-
fearing. He gave generously to the people and prayed to God regularly. 3 One day
at about the ninth hour, he had a clear vision of an angel of God who came to
him and said, "Cornelius!" 4 Cornelius stared at him in fear and asked, "What is it,
Lord?" The angel answered, "Your prayers and gifts to the poor have ascended as a
memorial offering before God." 5 Now send men to Joppa to call for a man named
Simon who is called Peter. 6 "He is staying with Simon the tanner, whose house is
by the sea." 7 When the angel who spoke to him had gone, Cornelius called two of
his servants and a devout soldier from among his attendants. 8 He explained what
had happened and sent them to Joppa. 9 The next day at about the sixth hour, as the
men were approaching the city on their journey, Peter went up on the roof to pray.
10 He became hungry and wanted something to eat, but while the meal was being
prepared, he fell into a trance. 11 He saw heaven open and something like a large
sheet being let down to earth by its four corners. 12 It contained all kinds of four-
footed animals and reptiles of the earth, as well as birds of the air. 13 Then a voice
said to him: "Get up, Peter, kill and eat!" 14 "No, Lord!" Peter answered. "I have
never eaten anything impure or unclean." 15 The voice spoke to him a second time:
"Do not call anything impure that God has made clean."

16 This happened three times, and all at once the sheet was taken back up
into heaven. 17 While Peter was puzzling over the meaning of the vision, the men
sent by Cornelius found Simon's house and approached the gate. 18 They called out
to ask if Simon called Peter was staying there. 19 As Peter continued to reflect on the
vision, the Spirit said to him, "Behold, three men are looking for you." 20 "So get up!
Go downstairs and accompany them without hesitation, because I have sent them."

21 So Peter went down to the men and said, "Here am I, the one you are looking
for. Why have you come?" 22 "Cornelius the centurion has sent us," they said. "He is
a righteous and God-fearing man with a good reputation among the whole Jewish
nation. A holy angel instructed him to request your presence in his home so he
could hear a message from you." 23 So Peter invited them in as his guests. And the
next day he got ready and went with them, accompanied by some of the brothers
from Joppa. 24 The following day he arrived in Caesarea, where Cornelius was
expecting them and had called together his relatives and close friends. 25 As Peter was
about to enter, Cornelius met him and fell at his feet to worship him. 26 But Peter
helped him up. "Stand up," he said, "I am only a man myself." 27 As Peter talked
with him, he went inside and found many people gathered together. 28 He said to
them, "You know how unlawful it is for a Jew to associate with a foreigner or visit
him. But God has shown me that I should not call any man impure or unclean."
29 "So when I was invited, I came without objection. I ask, then, why have you
sent for me?" 30 Cornelius answered: "Four days ago I was in my house praying at
this, the ninth hour. Suddenly a man in radiant clothing stood before me" 31 and
said, 'Cornelius, your prayer has been heard, and your gifts to the poor have been
remembered before God.'

32 Therefore send to Joppa for Simon, who is called Peter. He is a guest in the home
of Simon the tanner, by the sea.' 33 "So I sent for you immediately, and you were
kind enough to come. Now then, we are all here in the presence of God to listen to
everything the Lord has instructed you to tell us." 34 Then Peter began to speak: "I
now truly understand that God does not show favoritism," 35 but welcomes those
from every nation who fear Him and do what is right. 36 He has sent this message
to the people of Israel, proclaiming the gospel of peace through Jesus Christ,
who is Lord of all. 37 You yourselves know what has happened throughout Judea,
beginning in Galilee with the baptism that John proclaimed: 38 how God anointed
Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Spirit and with power, and how Jesus went around
doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, because God was
with Him. 39 We are witnesses of all that He did, both in the land of the Jews and in
Jerusalem. And although they put Him to death by hanging Him on a tree, 40 God
raised Him up on the third day and caused Him to be seen— 41 not by all the people,
but by the witnesses God had chosen beforehand, by us who ate and drank with
Him after He rose from the dead. 42 And He commanded us to preach to the people
and to testify that He is the One appointed by God to judge the living and the dead.
43 "All the prophets testify about Him that everyone who believes in Him receives
forgiveness of sins through His name." 44 While Peter was still speaking these words,
the Holy Spirit fell upon all who heard his message. 45 All the circumcised believers
who had accompanied Peter were astounded that the gift of the Holy Spirit had
been poured out even on the Gentiles. 46 For they heard them speaking in tongues
and exalting God. Then Peter said, 47 "Can anyone withhold the water to baptize
these people? They have received the Holy Spirit just as we have!" 48 So he ordered
that they be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ. Then they asked him to stay for
a few days.

11 The apostles and brothers throughout Judea soon heard that the Gentiles
also had received the word of God. 2 So when Peter went up to Jerusalem, the
circumcised believers took issue with him 3 and said, "You visited uncircumcised
men and ate with them." 4 But Peter began and explained to them the whole
sequence of events: 5 "I was in the city of Joppa praying, and in a trance I saw a vision
of something like a large sheet being let down from heaven by its four corners, and

it came right down to me." [6] I looked at it closely and saw four-footed animals of the earth, wild beasts, reptiles, and birds of the air. [7] Then I heard a voice saying to me, 'Get up, Peter, kill and eat.' [8] 'No, Lord,' I said, 'for nothing impure or unclean has ever entered my mouth.' [9] But the voice spoke from heaven a second time, 'Do not call anything impure that God has made clean.'

[10] This happened three times, and everything was drawn back up into heaven. [11] Just then three men sent to me from Caesarea stopped at the house where I was staying. [12] The Spirit told me to accompany them without hesitation. These six brothers also went with me, and we entered the man's home. [13] He told us how he had seen an angel standing in his house and saying, 'Send to Joppa for Simon who is called Peter.' [14] He will convey to you a message by which you and all your household will be saved.' [15] As I began to speak, the Holy Spirit fell upon them, just as He had fallen upon us at the beginning.

[16] Then I remembered the word of the Lord, as He used to say, 'John baptized with water, but you will be baptized with the Holy Spirit.' [17] "So if God gave them the same gift He gave us who believed in the Lord Jesus Christ, who was I to hinder the work of God?" [18] When they heard this, their objections were put to rest, and they glorified God, saying, "So then, God has granted even the Gentiles repentance unto life." [19] Meanwhile those scattered by the persecution that began with Stephen traveled as far as Phoenicia, Cyprus, and Antioch, speaking the message only to Jews.

[20] But some of them, men from Cyprus and Cyrene, went to Antioch and began speaking to the Greeks as well, proclaiming the good news about the Lord Jesus. [21] The hand of the Lord was with them, and a great number of people believed and turned to the Lord. [22] When news of this reached the ears of the church in Jerusalem, they sent Barnabas to Antioch. [23] When he arrived and saw the grace of God, he rejoiced and encouraged them all to abide in the Lord with all their hearts. [24] Barnabas was a good man, full of the Holy Spirit and faith, and a great number of people were brought to the Lord. [25] Then Barnabas went to Tarsus to look for Saul, [26] and when he found him, he brought him back to Antioch. So for a full year they met together with the church and taught large numbers of people. The disciples were first called Christians at Antioch. [27] In those days some prophets came down from Jerusalem to Antioch. [28] One of them named Agabus stood up and predicted through the Spirit that a great famine would sweep across the whole world. (This happened under Claudius.) [29] So the disciples, each according to his ability, decided to send relief to the brothers living in Judea. [30] This they did, sending their gifts to the elders with Barnabas and Saul.

12 About that time, King Herod reached out to harm some who belonged to the church. [2] He had James, the brother of John, put to death with the sword. [3] And seeing that this pleased the Jews, Herod proceeded to seize Peter during the Feast of Unleavened Bread. [4] He arrested him and put him in prison, handing him over to be guarded by four squads of four soldiers each. Herod intended to bring him out to the people after the Passover. [5] So Peter was kept in prison, but the church was fervently praying to God for him. [6] On the night before Herod was to bring him to trial, Peter was sleeping between two soldiers, bound with two chains, with sentries standing guard at the entrance to the prison. [7] Suddenly an angel of the Lord appeared and a light shone in the cell. He tapped Peter on the side and woke him up, saying, "Get up quickly." And the chains fell off his wrists.

[8] "Get dressed and put on your sandals," said the angel. Peter did so, and the angel told him, "Wrap your cloak around you and follow me." [9] So Peter followed him out, but he was unaware that what the angel was doing was real. He thought he was only seeing a vision. [10] They passed the first and second guards and came to the iron gate leading to the city, which opened for them by itself. When they had gone outside and walked the length of one block, the angel suddenly left him.

[11] Then Peter came to himself and said, "Now I know for sure that the Lord has sent His angel and rescued me from Herod's grasp and from everything the Jewish people were anticipating." [12] And when he had realized this, he went to the house of Mary the mother of John, also called Mark, where many people had gathered together and were praying. [13] He knocked at the outer gate, and a servant girl named Rhoda came to answer it. [14] When she recognized Peter's voice, she was so overjoyed that she forgot to open the gate, but ran inside and announced, "Peter is standing at the gate!" [15] "You are out of your mind," they told her. But when she kept insisting it was so, they said, "It must be his angel."

[16] But Peter kept on knocking, and when they opened the door and saw him, they were astounded. [17] Peter motioned with his hand for silence, and he described how the Lord had brought him out of the prison. "Send word to James and to the brothers," he said, and he left for another place. [18] At daybreak there was no small commotion among the soldiers as to what had become of Peter. [19] After Herod had searched for him unsuccessfully, he examined the guards and ordered that they be executed. Then he went down from Judea to Caesarea and spent some time there. [20] Now Herod was in a furious dispute with the people of Tyre and Sidon, and they convened before him. Having secured the support of Blastus, the king's chamberlain, they asked for peace, because their region depended on the king's country for food. [21] On the appointed day, Herod donned his royal robes, sat on his throne, and addressed the people. [22] And they began to shout, "This is the voice of a god, not a man!" [23] Immediately, because Herod did not give glory to God, an angel of the Lord struck him down, and he was eaten by worms and died. [24] But the word of God continued to spread and multiply. [25] When Barnabas and Saul had fulfilled their mission to Jerusalem, they returned, bringing with them John, also called Mark.

13 Now in the church at Antioch there were prophets and teachers: Barnabas, Simeon called Niger, Lucius of Cyrene, Manaen (who had been brought up with Herod the tetrarch), and Saul. [2] While they were worshiping the Lord and fasting, the Holy Spirit said, "Set apart for Me Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them." [3] And after they had fasted and prayed, they laid their hands on them and sent them off. [4] So Barnabas and Saul, sent forth by the Holy Spirit, went down to Seleucia and sailed from there to Cyprus. [5] When they arrived at Salamis, they proclaimed the word of God in the Jewish synagogues. And John was with them as their helper. [6] They traveled through the whole island as far as Paphos, where they found a Jewish sorcerer and false prophet named Bar-Jesus, [7] an attendant of the proconsul, Sergius Paulus. The proconsul, a man of intelligence, summoned Barnabas and Saul because he wanted to hear the word of God. [8] But Elymas the sorcerer (for that is what his name means) opposed them and tried to turn the proconsul from the faith. [9] Then Saul, who was also called Paul, filled with the Holy Spirit, looked directly at Elymas [10] and said, "O child of the devil and enemy of all righteousness, you are full of all kinds of deceit and trickery! Will you never stop perverting the straight ways of the Lord?" [11] "Now look, the hand of the Lord is against you, and for a time you will be blind and unable to see the light of the sun." Immediately mist and darkness came over him, and he groped about, seeking someone to lead him by the hand. [12] When the proconsul saw what had happened, he believed, for he was astonished at the teaching about the Lord. [13] After setting sail from Paphos, Paul and his companions came to Perga in Pamphylia, where John left them to return to Jerusalem. [14] And from Perga, they traveled inland to Pisidian Antioch, where they entered the synagogue on the Sabbath and sat down. [15] After the reading from the Law and the Prophets, the synagogue leaders sent word to them: "Brothers, if you have a word of encouragement for the people, please speak." [16] Paul stood up, motioned with his hand, and began to speak: "Men of Israel and you Gentiles who fear God, listen to me!"

[17] The God of the people of Israel chose our fathers. He made them into a great people during their stay in Egypt, and with an uplifted arm He led them out of that land. [18] He endured their conduct for about forty years in the wilderness. [19] And having vanquished seven nations in Canaan, He gave their land to His people as an inheritance. [20] All this took about 450 years. After this, God gave them judges until the time of Samuel the prophet. [21] Then the people asked for a king, and God gave them forty years under Saul son of Kish, from the tribe of Benjamin.

[22] After removing Saul, He raised up David as their king and testified about him: 'I have found David son of Jesse a man after My own heart; he will carry out My will in its entirety.' [23] From the descendants of this man, God has brought to Israel the Savior Jesus, as He promised. [24] Before the arrival of Jesus, John preached a baptism of repentance to all the people of Israel. [25] As John was completing his course, he said, 'Who do you suppose I am? I am not that One. But He is coming after me whose sandals I am not worthy to untie.' [26] Brothers, children of Abraham, and you Gentiles who fear God, it is to us that this message of salvation has been sent. [27] The people of Jerusalem and their rulers did not recognize Jesus, yet in condemning Him they fulfilled the words of the prophets that are read every Sabbath. [28] And though they found no ground for a death sentence, they asked Pilate to have Him executed. [29] When they had carried out all that was written about Him, they took Him down from the tree and laid Him in a tomb. [30] But God raised Him from the dead, [31] and for many days He was seen by those who had accompanied Him from Galilee to Jerusalem. They are now His witnesses to our people. [32] And now we proclaim to you the good news: What God promised our fathers [33] He has fulfilled for us, their children, by raising up Jesus. As it is written in the second Psalm: 'You are My Son; today I have become Your Father.'

[34] In fact, God raised Him from the dead, never to see decay. As He has said: 'I will give you the holy and sure blessings promised to David.' [35] So also, He says in another Psalm: 'You will not let Your Holy One see decay.' [36] For when David had served God's purpose in his own generation, he fell asleep. His body was buried with his fathers and saw decay. [37] But the One whom God raised from the dead did not see decay. [38] Therefore let it be known to you, brothers, that through Jesus the forgiveness of sins is proclaimed to you. [39] Through Him everyone who believes is justified from everything you could not be justified from by the law of Moses. [40] Watch out, then, that what was spoken by the prophets does not happen to you: [41] "'Look, you scoffers, wonder and perish! For I am doing a work in your days that you would never believe, even if someone told you.'" [42] As Paul and Barnabas were leaving the synagogue, the people urged them to continue this message on the next Sabbath. [43] After the synagogue was dismissed, many of the Jews and devout converts to Judaism followed Paul and Barnabas, who spoke to them and urged them to continue in the grace of God. [44] On the following Sabbath, nearly the whole city gathered to hear the word of the Lord. [45] But when the Jews saw

the crowds, they were filled with jealousy, and they blasphemously contradicted what Paul was saying. [46] Then Paul and Barnabas answered them boldly: "It was necessary to speak the word of God to you first. But since you reject it and do not consider yourselves worthy of eternal life, we now turn to the Gentiles." [47] "For this is what the Lord has commanded us: 'I have made you a light for the Gentiles, to bring salvation to the ends of the earth.'" [48] When the Gentiles heard this, they rejoiced and glorified the word of the Lord, and all who were appointed for eternal life believed. [49] And the word of the Lord spread throughout that region. [50] The Jews, however, incited the religious women of prominence and the leading men of the city. They stirred up persecution against Paul and Barnabas and drove them out of their district. [51] So they shook the dust off their feet in protest against them and went to Iconium. [52] And the disciples were filled with joy and with the Holy Spirit.

14 At Iconium, Paul and Barnabas went as usual into the Jewish synagogue, where they spoke so well that a great number of Jews and Greeks believed. [2] But the unbelieving Jews stirred up the Gentiles and poisoned their minds against the brothers. [3] So Paul and Barnabas spent considerable time there, speaking boldly for the Lord, who affirmed the message of His grace by enabling them to perform signs and wonders. [4] The people of the city were divided. Some sided with the Jews, and others with the apostles. [5] But when the Gentiles and Jews, together with their rulers, set out to mistreat and stone them, [6] they found out about it and fled to the Lycaonian cities of Lystra and Derbe and to the surrounding region, [7] where they continued to preach the gospel. [8] In Lystra there sat a man crippled in his feet, who was lame from birth and had never walked.

[9] This man was listening to the words of Paul, who looked intently at him and saw that he had faith to be healed. [10] In a loud voice Paul called out, "Stand up on your feet!" And the man jumped up and began to walk. [11] When the crowds saw what Paul had done, they lifted up their voices in the Lycaonian language: "The gods have come down to us in human form!" [12] Barnabas they called Zeus, and Paul they called Hermes, because he was the chief speaker.